

ODYSSEUS



GOAL OF THE GAME

Sail with Ulysses across the Mediterranean, as he faces the trials thrown at him by the gods of Olympus.

Help Ulysses navigate the perils that could jeopardise his voyage home to Ithaca.

Strength, Luck, Cunning and Intelligence: Refine your skills during the voyage to surmount the 15 major challenges that threaten to thwart Ulysses' return journey.

Every peril you overcome, and every tale you gather, will score you victory points, edging Ulysses ever closer to his homeland.

Now is the time for you to write a new epic!

COMPONENTS



1 Ulysses' Ship gameboard



5 Tales player boards



20 wooden cubes
(5 red, 5 blue,
5 yellow et 5 green)



5 Epic tiles



28 Tale tiles



40 Athena's Favor
tokens



60 Trial cards



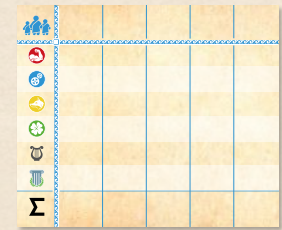
5 player aid cards



16 Automa cards



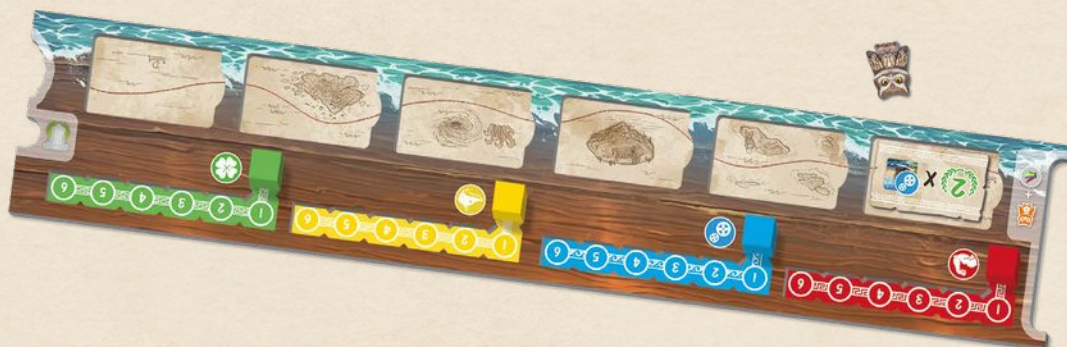
4 Automa
Difficulty tiles



1 score pad

SETUP

- 1 Place Ulysses' Ship in the center of the table.
- 2 Shuffle the 28 Tale tiles. Create 2 facedown stacks on the corresponding spaces on Ulysses' Ship. Reveal the top 4 Tale tiles from one of the two stacks and place them in the specific spaces on the Ship.
- 3 Draw the corresponding number of Trial cards for the player count (as shown on Ulysses' Ship). Shuffle them and form a facedown stack on the appropriate space on Ulysses' Ship.
- 4 Draw 4 Trial cards from the stack and place them face down on the 4 central spaces either side of Ulysses' Ship.
- 5 Draw 8 Trial cards from the stack and place them face up on the other spaces around the ship.
- 6 Place 1 Athena's Favor token on each side of Ulysses' Ship. Form a supply with the remaining Athena's Favor tokens.
- 7 Create a stack with the 5 Epic tiles, placing them in value order and with the largest value at the top of the stack. Place this stack on its space on Ulysses' Ship.
- 8 Finally, give each player:
 - 1 Tales player board and 4 wooden cubes (1 of each color). Place each cube on the 0 space matching its color.
 - 1 Tale tile from one of the two facedown stacks.
 - 1 Athena's Favor token from the supply.
 - 1 Player aid card.
- 9 The first player is the person who last sailed on a boat.



HOW TO PLAY

Starting with the first player, take turns clockwise. The game ends when each player holds 11 Trial cards.

ANATOMY OF A TRIAL CARD

The Trial cards represent the 15 major stages of Ulysses' voyage across the Mediterranean. Your goal is to help Ulysses succeed in these trials, in order to score victory points at the end of the game. The Trials feature these 4 skills, each with its own color:

 Strength /  Intelligence /  Cunning /  Luck

ANATOMY OF A TRIAL CARD

- 1 The value you require in that skill to pass this Trial.
- 2 The number of victory points you score if you pass this Trial.
- 3 What you gain when you choose to depart on adventure with this card.
- 4 The type of trial:  Navigation,  Encounters,  Gods,  Creatures,  Ithaca.



ON YOUR TURN

Play through the following steps, in this order:

1 Choose a Trial card

2 Depart on an Adventure, or Rest

3 End your turn

1 CHOOSE A TRIAL CARD

Choose 1 Trial card from one of the ends of the two lines either side of Ulysses' Ship: You cannot choose a Trial card that is between 2 cards.

If the card next to the Trial card is face down, immediately flip up the two facedown cards on that side of the ship, and take the Athena's Favor token between them.



EXAMPLE: Aliko can choose between 3 Trial cards: 1, 2 or 3. She chooses 2, which is adjacent to a facedown card. She flips the 2 facedown cards on that side of Ulysses' Ship and takes the Athena's Favor token between them.

2.A DEPART ON AN ADVENTURE

Once you have chosen a Trial card, apply the bonuses shown at the bottom of the card, as explained below.

Keep track of your level for a skill by moving that wooden cube along its track.

    : Add 1 to the skill shown.

 : Add 1 to a skill of your choice.

 : Receive 1 Athena's Favor token from the supply.

Next, place that Trial card on your Tales board above the column that corresponds to that skill.

IMPORTANT: You cannot have more than 4 Trial cards above your Tales board for each skill. If you have no option other than to choose a 5th skill card, you must use it to Rest instead.



EXAMPLE: Aliko chooses a Trial card and decides to Depart on an Adventure. She adds 2 to her Cunning. Then she places that Trial card in the Luck column above her Tales board.

2.B REST

Place your Trial card face down to the left of your Tales board, without applying any of its bonuses.

In exchange, you can add 1 to a skill of your choice  and gain 1 Athena's Favor token  from the supply.

EXAMPLE: Nikos chooses to Rest and so places his Trial card face down to the left of his Tales board. He decides to add 1 to his Strength. He also gains 1 Athena's Favor token from the supply.



3 END YOUR TURN

If there is only 1 Trial card on Ulysses' Ship at the end of your turn, discard that card. Refill the Ship by placing 4 cards face down and 8 cards face up in their respective spaces.

Next, place 1 Athena's Favor token  on each side of Ulysses' Ship.

Play then passes to the player on your left.

TALES

Tale tiles give you extra victory points at the end of the game. Your points depend on which Trial cards you have. There are 14 different Tales:

4 that relate to a skill type:



5 that relate to an exact skill value:



5 that relate to a Trial type:



There are 2 of each Tale in the game. Each Tale scores 2 victory points for each of that item on the Trial cards you hold.

IMPORTANT: You score the victory points for your Tale tiles even if you do not pass the corresponding Trial cards at the end of the game.

GATHERING A TALE

There are 2 ways you can gather a Tale, and you cannot have more than 6 Tales:

- 1 By spending 3 Athena's Favor tokens. You may only do this once per turn (see Athena's Favor, p.7).
- 2 Each time you build a row of 4 Trial cards that contains 1 of each skill:

 Strength +  Intelligence +  Cunning +  Luck

When you gather a Tale, you can either choose 1 of the 4 faceup Tale tiles or draw the top Tale tile from one of the two facedown stacks. If you choose a faceup Tale tile, replace it with the top Tale tile from one of the two stacks.



EXAMPLE: Yannis has completed their first line of Trial cards and so gathers a Tale. They choose a Tale that gives them 2 victory points for each Trial of value 1 or 2 that they hold at the end of the game, whether they pass those Trials or not.

To complete an Epic, you must hold a Trial card of each type:

 Navigation +  Encounters +  Gods +  Creatures +  Ithaca.

Take the top Epic tile and place it to the right of your Tales board.

The victory points for the Epic tiles decrease in value through the stack. You can only gain 1 Epic tile during the game.

ATHENA'S FAVOR

You can use Athena's Favor tokens to choose a different skill to increase, or to gain a Tale.

- 1 Once during your turn, you can spend 3 Athena's Favor tokens  to gain a Tale.
- 2 Alternatively, you can spend 1 Athena's Favor token  to increase a different skill from the one stated. You are allowed to do this each time you add 1 to a skill value.

EXAMPLE: Nikos has chosen a Trial card that adds 2 to his Cunning. He decides to use 1 Athena's Favor token to add 1 of those points to his Luck instead. This means he adds 1 point to his Cunning and 1 point to his Luck.



END OF THE GAME

The game ends when there is only one card left on Ulysses' Ship and no cards left in the draw pile. Proceed to scoring.

For each of your skills, count the victory points on your Trial cards where your skill value is equal to or exceeds that Trial's difficulty level. You have passed those Trials.

Next, count the victory points on your Tale tiles. Reminder: your Tales give you victory points for all your Trial cards, even if their difficulty level exceeds your skill value.

Finally, add the victory points on your Epic tile.

The winner is the player who scores the most points. In case of a tie, the winner is the player who scored the most points for their Tales. If there is still a tie, the players share the victory.

CREDITS

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WARNING! Not suitable for children under 3 years, because small parts could be swallowed.



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SOLO MODE

SETUP

Set up the game as you would for 2 players. Step 7 applies only to you.
Choose the Automa's difficulty level for this game: 1, 2, 3 or 4.
Give the Automa the corresponding number of Tale tiles for the difficulty level you have chosen: 2, 3, 4 or 5.
Finally, shuffle the 16 Automa cards to form a facedown draw pile.



HOW TO PLAY

You are the first player, as the Automa cannot travel by boat.
Take your turn as in the standard game, then play the Automa's turn. Continue likewise.
The game ends when the Automa holds 11 Trial cards.

AUTOMA'S TURN

Draw the top card of the Automa draw pile and perform one of the following 2 actions:

- 1 If the Automa card contains a symbol:



Discard the 4 Tale tiles on Ulysses' Ship and replace them.



Following the arrows and respecting its order of priority, the Automa chooses the first available Trial card that will give it 1 Athena's Favor token. Its turn then ends. If it cannot take a token, the Automa instead chooses a card as described in Step 2.

- 2 Following the arrows and respecting its order of priority, the Automa chooses the first available Trial card.

In all cases, if the Trial card chosen by the Automa is adjacent to a facedown card, flip up the 2 facedown cards on that side of Ulysses' Ship and discard the Athena's Favor token between them.

TALES

The Automa starts the game with the Tales that correspond to the difficulty level chosen. It does not gain any other Tales during the game.

EPIC

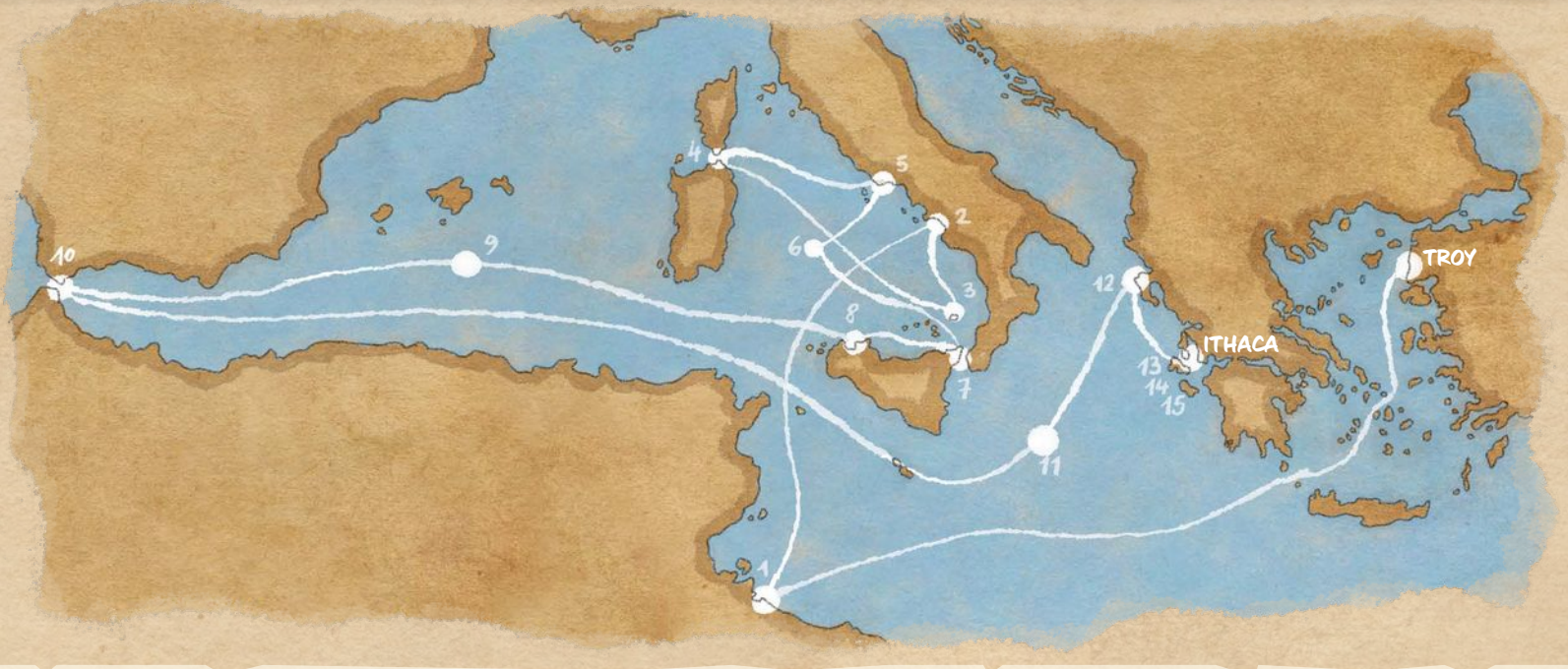
As soon as the Automa holds the 5 different types of Trial card (+ + + +), it gains the first available Epic tile.

END OF THE GAME

Proceed to scoring, counting up your victory points in the usual way.
For the Automa, add the victory points for its Tale tiles and its Epic tile to the victory points for the difficulty level chosen.
You win the game if you score more points than the Automa.



ULYSSES' ODYSSEY



Ulysses is a legendary hero in Greek mythology. As king of Ithaca, he was known for his intelligence, cunning and courage. He is one of the main characters in the *Odyssey*, an epic composed in the 8th century BC and believed to have been written by the Greek poet Homer.

After the Trojan war, Ulysses spent ten years journeying back to his homeland, encountering many perils on his way, including various monsters, tempests, hostile gods and temptations. Ulysses' voyage became a representation of man's struggle with adversity. Supported by the goddess Athena, his triumph can be attributed more to cunning than to strength.

Ulysses' tale resonates with us not only as a physical voyage back home, but also as an internal journey pierced through with loss, patience and wisdom.

The *Odyssey* is a fundamental work within the canon of Western literature, and explores universal themes such as identity, loyalty, homecoming and the quest for self.

ATHENA



In Greek mythology, Athena is traditionally represented by a Little Owl. She is the goddess who protects Ulysses and assists him during his voyage, giving him counsel and intervening on his behalf among the other gods.

1. LOTUS EATERS



Ulysses and his men arrive at the land of the Lotus Eaters, who consume lotuses for their soporific effects. Some of his companions, being seduced by the fruits' effects, forget their mission and wish to remain there. Ulysses forces them back to the ship to avoid losing his crew.

2. POLYPHEMUS



After Ulysses and his men are captured by the cyclops Polyphemus, they use wine to put him to sleep, and gouge out his eye, and then escape by hanging beneath Polyphemus' sheep. But pride causes Ulysses to reveal his name, provoking Polyphemus to anger. Polyphemus calls upon Poseidon to avenge him.

3. ΛΕΟΛΙΑ



Ulysses is welcomed by Aeolus, ruler of the winds, who offers him a bag that contains all the winds except the one that would propel him towards Ithaca. Ulysses' companions, believing they have found something of great worth, open the bag in secret. This allows the winds to escape, causing a tempest that draws Ulysses' ship further away from Ithaca.



4. LAESTRYGONIANS



After leaving the island of Aeolia, Ulysses moors at the land of the Laestrygonians, a tribe of cannibalistic giants. His men are captured and devoured, then the Laestrygonians throw rocks at Ulysses' fleet and destroy it. Only Ulysses' ship escapes the massacre.

5. CIRCE



Ulysses moors at the island where the witch-goddess Circe resides, and she turns his men into pigs. But with the help of Hermes and using a magical plant, Ulysses is able to resist her spells and forces her to return his companions to human form. Circe becomes an ally and provides them with shelter for a year.

6. THE SIRENS



To resist the fatal song of the sirens, Ulysses blocks the ears of his crew and ties himself to the mast. Seduced by the siren song, he begs to be untied, but his companions cannot hear him. This allows the crew to sail the ship out of reach of the sirens' call.

7. SCYLLA AND CHARYBDIS



Ulysses crosses a strait guarded by two monsters: Charybdis, a giant whirlpool, and Scylla, a creature with six heads. To save his ship, Ulysses chooses to pass close to Scylla, where he loses six men but escapes the clutches of Charybdis.

8. HELIOS' SACRED CATTLE



On the island of Thrinacia, despite being warned, Ulysses' famished crew kill the sacred cattle of the god Helios, which his daughters are guarding. The crew's disobedience provokes the divine wrath of Zeus.

9. ZEUS' WRATH



By eating the sacred cattle of Helios, Ulysses' companions provoke the wrath of Zeus. He releases a tempest that destroys their ship and kills the entire crew. Ulysses is the only survivor, and drifts towards the island where Calypso resides.

10. CALYPSO



Ulysses' ship runs aground on the island of Ogygia, where the nymph Calypso keeps him captive for seven years. She offers him immortality but he wishes to return home. On the orders of Zeus, Hermes demands that Ulysses is released. Calypso allows this and helps Ulysses leave.

11. POSEIDON'S WRATH



Polyphemus summons his father, Poseidon, to punish Ulysses. Furious, Poseidon makes Ulysses' voyage interminable, thwarting him with tempests and shipwrecks, until the gods of Olympus compel Poseidon to cease his vengeance.

12. ARRIVAL AMONG THE PHAEACIANS



Ulysses is shipwrecked and then welcomed by Nausicaa in the land of the Phaeacians. During a banquet, he reveals his identity and tells of his adventures. Emotionally affected by Ulysses' tale, Alcinous provides an enchanted ship to return Ulysses to his homeland.

13. REACHING ITHACA



Ulysses is asleep on the Phaeacians' ship when it reaches Ithaca. Athena transforms him into a beggar to help him reclaim his throne. Now unrecognizable, he plans his return with the help of those still loyal to him, and his son Telemachus.

14. RETURN TO THE PALACE



Ulysses visits the palace, disguised as a beggar. He finds Telemachus and plots his revenge. Ulysses observes the contenders to the throne, tests the loyalty of the servants and plans to use his cunning to reclaim his crown.

15. ARCHERY CONTEST



Ulysses attends an archery contest organised by Penelope: Flex Ulysses' bow and shoot an arrow through twelve ax heads. None of the contenders succeed. Ulysses attempts the test, succeeds, reveals his identity and then kills the other contenders, with the help of Telemachus.